



Nokia 1020 Launched

Finally, the 41MP WP8 smartphone long rumoured has been launched, and will hit stores in Q3 2013. <http://dgit.in/1axGmDo>



Tumblr for iOS update

Tumblr recommends a security update that fixes a flaw for iOS users. Read the Tumblr staff blog post for more information: <http://dgit.in/14cFeRU>

Camera Test

HOW WE TESTED

The goal of our test this time was to determine which camera would give the best image quality not just at varying ISO's, but also with varying shooting conditions. As a camera that's going to go everywhere with you, we also wanted to make sure the video features on these shooters was up to the task of documenting our all your precious moments.

We divided our tests into three parts, two for stills and one for video. One set of tests involved shooting a simulated test target in controlled light to measure color depth and accuracy, white balance accuracy and lens sharpness in the corners and center. A controlled test target also helps determine the

ISO performance of a camera. We also devised our test target to measure dynamic range by including pure black, pure white and neutral grey areas which would effectively measure the sensor's ability to capture various levels of illumination. All test target shots were taken in Program mode as most of these cameras do not have an Aperture Priority mode.

Second phase of the testing involved getting outside the studio and shooting with each of the cameras in a "real world" scenario. We included several kinds of still life, lots of landscape, some macro along with the usual people shots. For our low light testing, we resorted to taking a lot of street shots at generally high ISO and

wide apertures. We also shot coloured targets in a relatively dimly lit room to see how good the colour accuracy would be in low light/high ISO conditions, along with sharpness across the board.

Video performance was tested both indoors and outdoors and while the outdoor filming allowed us to gauge the dynamic range and audio prowess of each of the cameras, the indoor tests allowed us to have a true measure of how well the sensor can curtail and snub noise. We also tested how well the cameras could maintain and track focus using some very energetic little children and a particularly naughty puppy.

with. That explains why, for example, despite some Canon cameras having the same Digic 5 chips, show subtle differences in performance.

All the cameras in our shootout have pretty similar features, except for the select few that sport a much larger zoom range (such as the Fujifilm S4800 and the Nikon L820) or brag of on-board Wi-Fi connectivity (Nikon S5200, Nikon S6500, and the Canon Ixus 140 and 255 HS). While the zoom range is a nice bonus, what we're particularly looking for is the real add-ons such as Wi-Fi and GPS. We gave extra points to those cameras that had these features. Scene modes, for all of those who crave them, are present on all cameras, in much larger number on some than the others (though some of them are just the same effects with different names).

Design is a fundamental aspect of any camera. After all, when you see a camera from afar, it's the looks that will first attract you. While the Fujifilm and Nikon super-zooms both have great balance and looks, but they are incredibly heavy. The Panasonic Lumix DMC-SZ3

is incredibly light and comes in various vibrant colours, but the plastic it is made of doesn't really offer much reassurance against drops. While all the cameras are made of plastic, the Nikon S6500 and the Canon Ixus 255 HS are made from particularly high grade plastic and sport a very pleasing finish.

BUILD AND ERGONOMICS

We take evaluating the build quality and ergonomics of cameras very seriously. It is incredibly difficult to take a good photo if you can't comfortably hold your camera, or if the buttons are placed in a non-intuitive way. In our testing of

the various cameras, we found something rather interesting. The Nikons not only come with exceptional build quality, but also sported buttons with an excellent finish and enough feedback to make pressing them rather comfortable.

What surprised us was that the quality of the buttons on the Canons was somewhat mediocre, especially the switch that toggles between Auto and Program modes. The one on the Ixus 125 felt especially weak. On the other hand, the Canon PowerShot SX240 HS feels like a mini tank, with extremely study build quality and a very well-built mode dial on the back that we definitely stress-tested

by turning it like a turn-table. In our DSLR test, we found that it was the Canons that had better build and ergonomics than the Nikons, but in this case, it seems to be the other way round. The most annoying thing about the Canon cameras is the removal of the physical "delete" button. Someone in the UI design team thought it would be a great idea to remove the button, which was a huge mistake as far as we're concerned. Now you have to waddle through the playback menu to do a simple task like deleting a picture you don't like.

The one camera that stood out for its poor ergonomics happens to be the Ixus 500 HS. Not only is the camera rather sharp edged, but the buttons on the back are packed quite tightly together, which makes it common to accidentally press the wrong button. The buttons too are somewhat hard to press, with minimal feedback.

The Nikon S6500 and the Canon SX240 HS top the build and ergonomic charts in our labs, thanks to their sturdy build, good button placement and an overall comfortable grip, thanks to the cameras being relatively light.



Panasonic SZ3